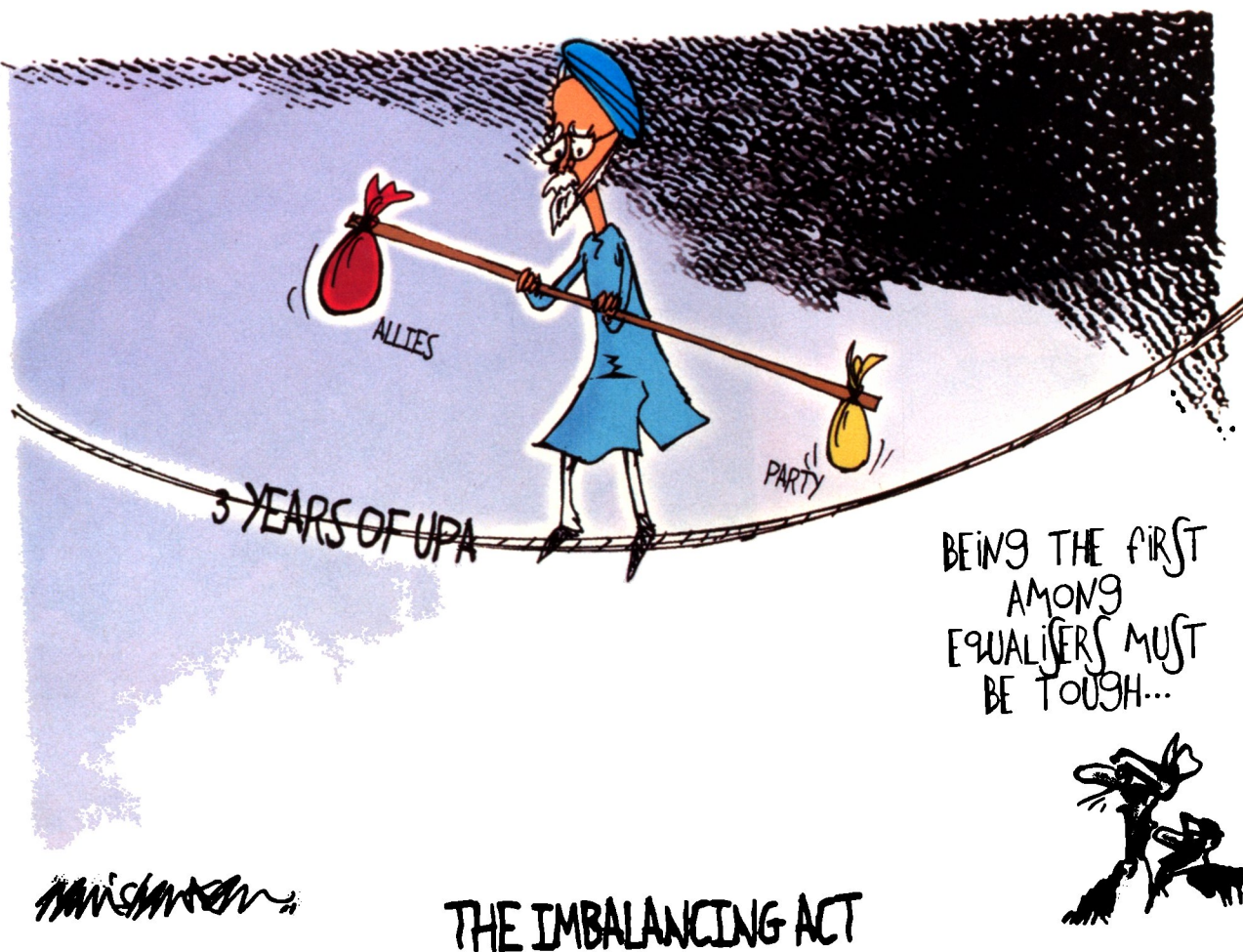




THE BUZZ OF THE WEEK

Mayawati's new and potent Dalit-Brahmin combine may take its toll sooner than later. A number of senior and second-rung leaders in the Congress, particularly from poll-bound states, are already toying with the idea of joining the BSP.

VOICES



"The masses determine who will form the Government, but the classes determine what that Government will do."

Mani Shankar Aiyar, Union minister for panchayati raj

"We're faced with a galloping demand for products which has resulted in inflation becoming a cause of concern, particularly in the case of essential commodities."

Manmohan Singh, prime minister

"Left Front partners are not untouchables. Our differences are issue-specific, not political or ideological. I think this is a turning point in the politics of West Bengal."

Mamata Banerjee, Trinamool Congress chief

"Bilateralism has failed. Manmohan Singh should talk to BJP, the Left and the rightists for a consensus on J&K and other issues on which progress has been made with Pakistan."

Mirwaiz Umar Farooq, Hurriyat Conference leader

"All that Cannes has become now is a glamour platform. Let us not fool ourselves anymore by saying big things and have big screening of our films and think that all is well."

Rituparno Ghosh, filmmaker

